Progression · Canvas · Series

waterfall

A bridge from one total to another through signed contributions, each bar starting where the last one ended.

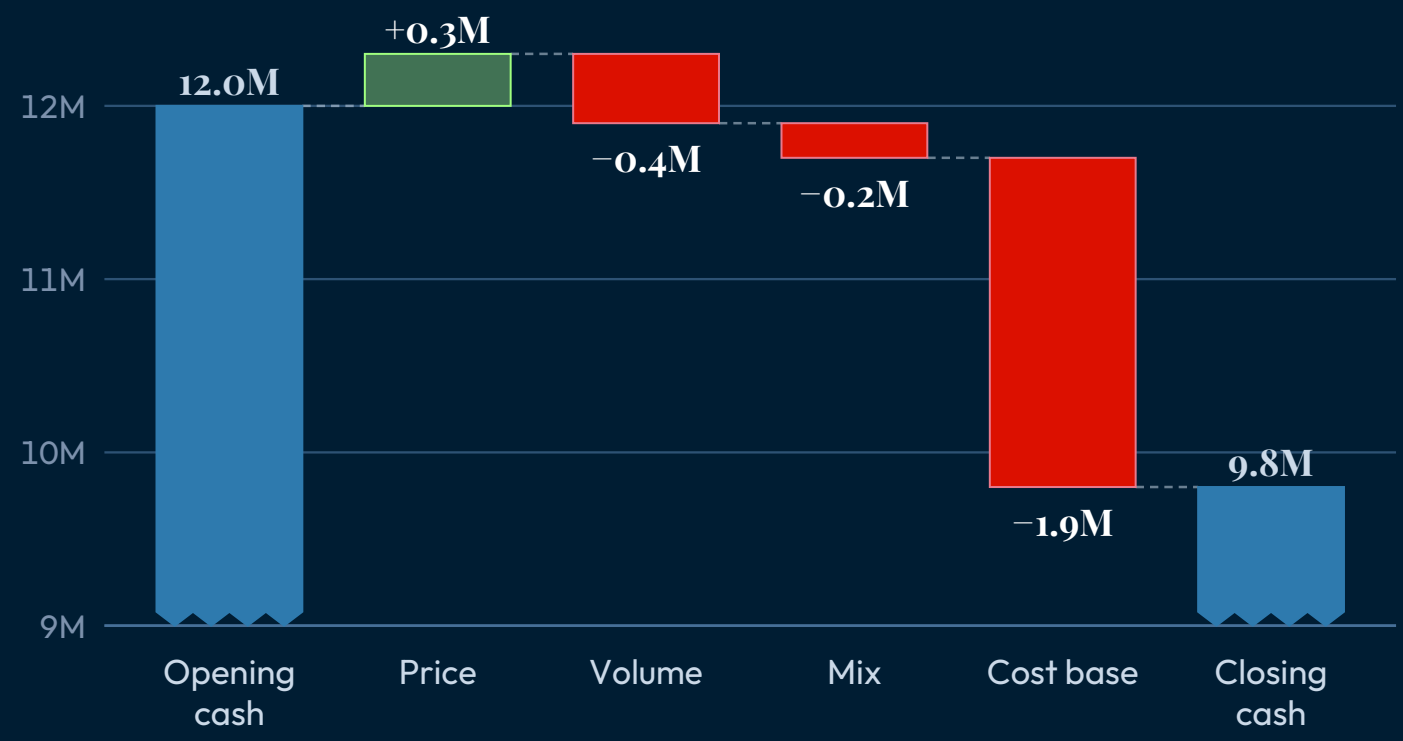
FY26 plan · actual

Price paid for the volume we lost.



FY26 · cash

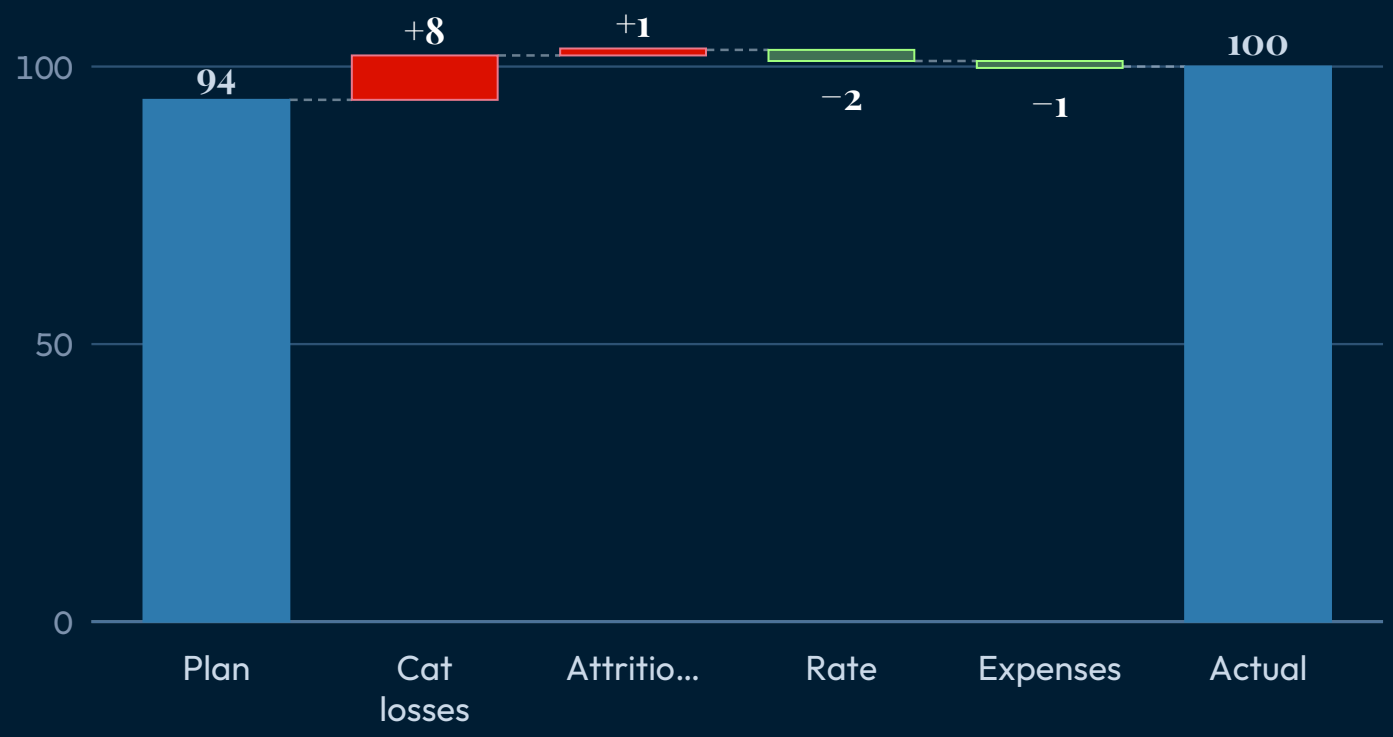
The drivers are the story, so the anchors are cut.



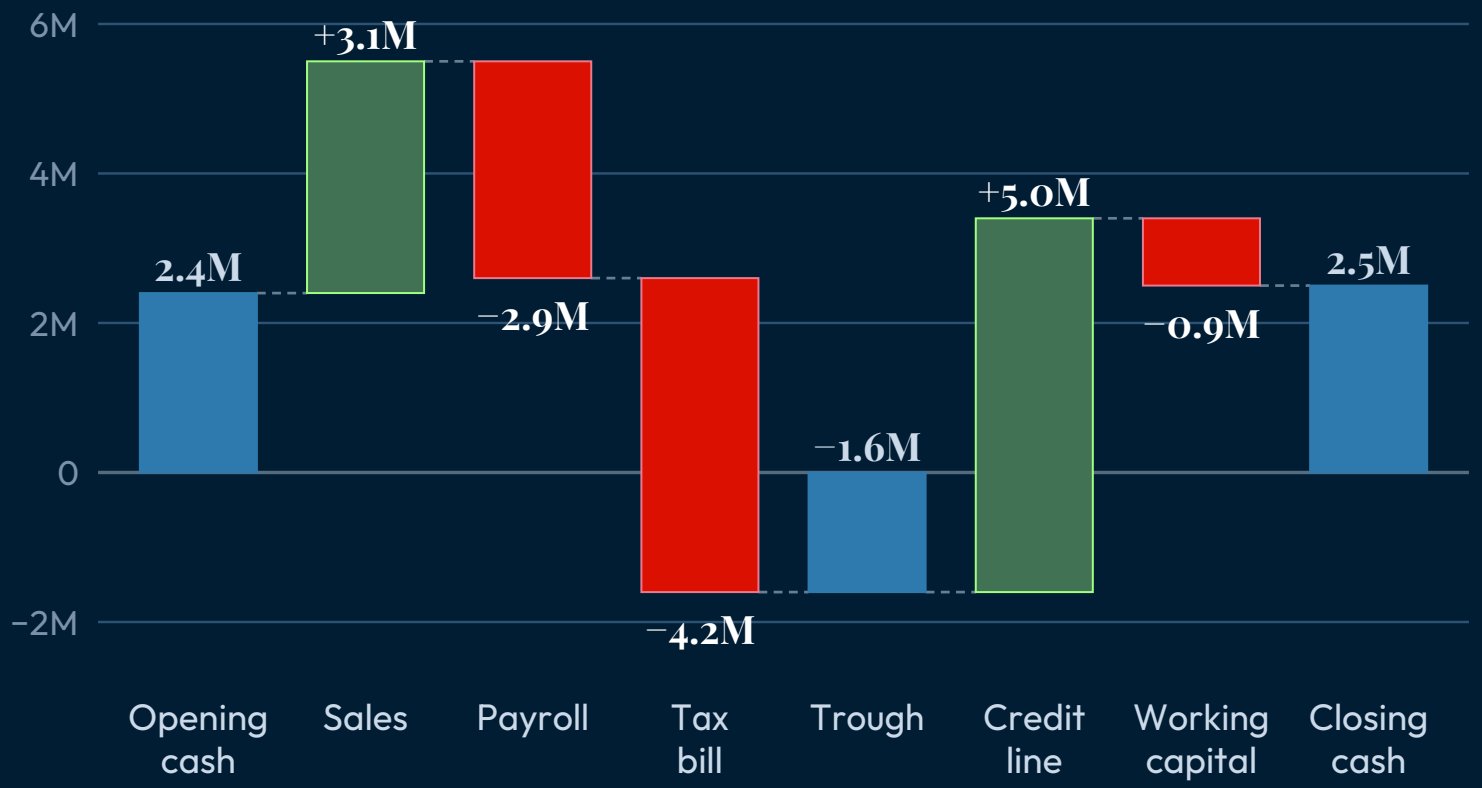
zoom · waterfall zoom — Re-bases the axis on the walk; the tear marks the clipped anchors.

Combined ratio · %

Cat losses pushed the combined ratio 6 points above plan.



The quarter we went negative and came back.



FY26 plan · actual

Price paid for the volume we lost.



FY26 plan · actual

Price paid for the volume we lost.



FY26 plan · actual

Price paid for the volume we lost.



When NOT to reach for waterfall.

Independent magnitudes with no running total

Revenue by region, spend by department — nothing accumulates, so the floating geometry is a lie. Use `bar`.

Parts of one total, all positive

Every contribution a positive share of one whole is a stack, not a walk: use `stacked-bar`, or `piechart` for one total.

When NOT to reach for waterfall.

A monotonic pipeline that narrows

Visitors to signups to paid is a subset at every stage, not signed contributions. Use `funnel`, whose taper IS the rate.

Drivers that are 1% of the anchors

A walk from 12.0M to 11.9M in steps of 20k is two anchors and a row of hairlines. Say it in a `big-number` instead.

Related components

See also.

`bar` — the categories are independent magnitudes with no running total, or you want the drivers alone without the anchors

`stacked-bar` — the contributions are all positive parts of one total rather than signed changes to it

`funnel` — each stage is a subset of the one before and the drop-off rate is the story

`big-number` — the net movement is the whole point and the drivers are not worth a slide

`line` — the total moved over time and you want the shape of the path, not the attribution